



**free will
and
determinism**

against
compatibilist
free will

against
incompatibilist
free will

More precisely, our topic is the relationship between freedom of the will and determinism, and a cluster of arguments which seem to show that free will is incompatible with both determinism and indeterminism, and hence impossible.

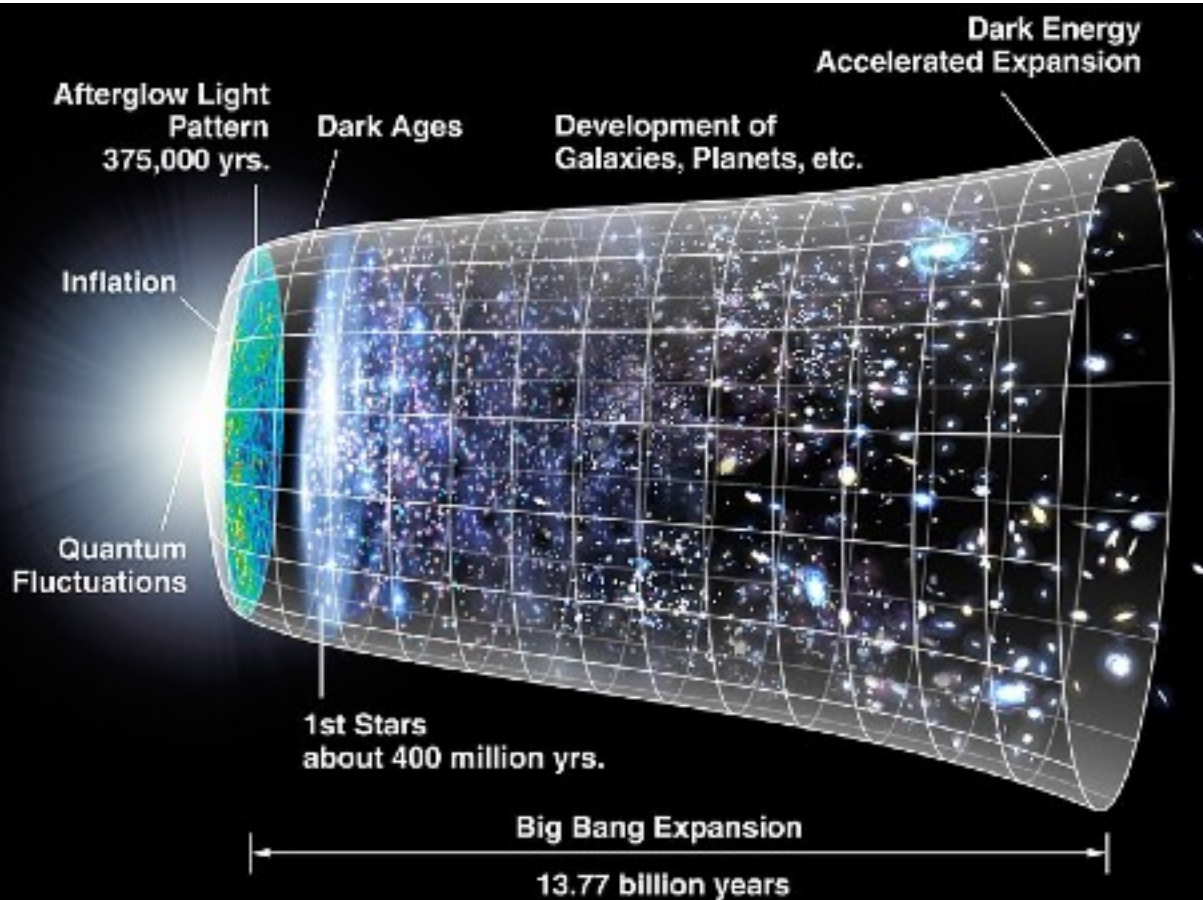
What is 'determinism'?

Consider a timeline of the history of the universe.

What determinism says is that, given a full specification of the state of the universe at one time, the laws of nature tell you exactly what will happen at every later time.

Our topic today is the challenge to free will posed by determinism.

"Determinism is the thesis that only one continuation of the state of things at a given moment is consistent with the laws of nature."



Sometimes people use 'determinism' as a name for the thesis that there is no free will, so that determinism rules out free will by definition. That is not how we are using the term. Determinism is a thesis about the laws of the nature. It is then an open question whether we could have free will in a world with deterministic laws.

Let's focus in on that question:



This gives us three possible views about freedom of the will.

Compatibilism

Freedom of the
will is real, and
compatible with
determinism.

Libertarianism

Freedom of the
will is real, and
incompatible with
determinism.

There is no free
will.

Just by thinking about it, we can see that exactly one of these must be true. If free will is real, one of the left two boxes must be true; and if free will is not real, the rightmost box is true.

The argument we are going to talk about today capitalizes on this fact.

The **master argument against free will** tries to show that both of the

left two boxes are false.

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6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

happened in the distant past.

and none has any choice about whether,

3. If determined, the only one

future is not distant with the state of the

theorie about the fact that if DNR

then DECISION. (4,5)

about whether @.

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

1. No one has any choice about events which



of interest.

2. None has any choice about DIDS ATJR.

5. No one has any choice about what the laws

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

varlatatie + the last of the last



4. If determinism is true, the laws of

then DECISION happens. (3)

C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

if P , then Q , then one has any choice

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)

This argument seems to show that the

one has any choice about the past, no

combination of four - that No

choice about the laws of nature, then no



rules out free will.

choice principle, and determinism

Since the first three of these theses

dearminism.

hence that free will is incompatible with

seem quite plausible, the argument

true, there are no free actions — and

seems to show that if determinism is







1. Freewill is incompatible with determinism.

0: There is no fire will.

2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free

Wili.



Real/|the master argument:

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks



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A large red circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is arranged in three lines, centered within the circle.

**against
incompatibilist
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We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the

reality of free will.



2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.

Wili.



0. There is no fire in.



believe in free will rejects premise (2).

Compatibility believers in free will reject premise (1). An incompatibilist

for (2), and one for (3).

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

A large orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text 'against compatibilist free will' in white. The text is centered and arranged in three lines.

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[REDACTED]

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